

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 2
♥ J 10 8 5 4
♦ 10 7 3 2
♣ A 9 4

♠ A 8 3
♥ A 7
♦ K J 9 6 4
♣ Q J 5



♠ K J 4
♥ K Q 9 2
♦ A Q 5
♣ K 10 8

♠ Q 10 9 7 6 5
♥ 6 3
♦ 8
♣ 7 6 3 2

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1NT	Pass	6NT

All Pass

6NT by North

With balanced distribution and 16 points NORTH should open 1NT rather than 1♦.

SOUTH's response is based on simple math. He adds his 18 points to the 15 minimum that NORTH has announced and comes up with 33 points combined. This is enough for a small slam, and since he has balanced distribution he bids 6NT.

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q J 10 9 6

♥ A 7

♦ A Q 6

♣ A K 7

♠ A 8 7 2

♥ J 9 2

♦ 10 9 7

♣ J 3 2



♠ K 4

♥ Q 10 6

♦ 8 5 3 2

♣ Q 9 8 5

♠ 5 3

♥ K 8 5 4 3

♦ K J 4

♣ 10 6 4

WEST is right at the maximum for a 1♠ opening bid
- one more point and he would have opened 2♣.

EAST does not have 3-card ♠ support but with 7
points must make some response. She cannot bid at
the 2-level so she says 1NT (6-10 points).

WEST is fine with Notrump so he bids 3NT.

West

1♠

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

North

Pass

East

1NT

South

Pass

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 5
 ♥ 7 3
 ♦ 6 5 4 2
 ♣ K Q 10 8 7 5

♠ A K 9 6 4

♥ K Q 5

♦ K Q J 7

♣ 3



♠ 7 2
 ♥ 10 9 8 6 2
 ♦ 9 8 3
 ♣ A J 4

♠ Q J 10 8 3

♥ A J 4

♦ A 10

♣ 9 6 2

SOUTH has a minimum 1 ♠ opening bid - 13 points and five trumps. She doesn't even suspect what's about to befall!

NORTH hears the 1 ♠ bid and all he wants to know is whether SOUTH has one, two or three Aces. So he uses the Blackwood convention, 4NT.

SOUTH has two Aces so she bids 5 ♥ (5 ♣ would show zero Aces, 5 ♦ would show one Ace, etc).

NORTH has heard enough and bids 6 ♠.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♥
Pass	6 ♠		
All Pass			
6 ♠ by South			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 6 2
♥ A K 8 7 6 2
♦ A 10 3
♣ A 9

♠ K J 8 3

♥ J 9 4

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 10 4 2



♠ A 7 4

♥ Q 5

♦ K 7 6 4

♣ 7 6 5 3

♠ Q 10 9 5

♥ 10 3

♦ Q J 9

♣ K Q J 8

WEST has an above-minimum strength hand with a good 6-card suit. He opens 1♥.

EAST, with 9 points, is a little too weak to bid at the 2-level so she bids a catchall 1NT.

WEST shows his 6-card suit and extra strength by jumping to 3♥, which EAST raises to 4♥ since two trumps is now adequate support.

West	North	East	South
1♥	Pass	1NT	Pass
3♥	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			
4♥ by West			

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 6 5
♥ J 9 6 5
♦ K Q 8 4
♣ 10 3

♠ K Q 7 4

♥ 8 3

♦ 7 6 2

♣ A K Q 2



♠ 9 2

♥ K 10 2

♦ A 10 9

♣ J 9 8 5 4

♠ J 10 8 3

♥ A Q 7 4

♦ J 5 3

♣ 7 6

NORTH has 14 points and opens her 4-card ♣ suit.

SOUTH must respond, and with two 4-card Majors bids them "up-the-line", saying 1 ♥.

NORTH now shows his 4-card ♠ suit, and SOUTH again must bid. Since SOUTH is pretty weak he just raises to 2 ♠, which NORTH happily passes.

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♥
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠
All Pass			
2 ♠ by North			